

INITIAL FEEDBACK ON RANGELAND DEGRADATION ASSESSMENT REPORT

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1. We really appreciate the thoughts and scholarly inputs this far and grateful to WFP, UoN, CGG, Garissa University, KEFRI, NDMA and other equally institutions who supported the study in form of funds and in kind.
 2. Citations on pages 1-2: Be fair to the contributions by the hardworking team that went to the field to collect data, who had put their full input while in fieldwork (multi-tasking in terms of ecology, soils, taxonomy and plant uses (scientifically and on indigenous knowledge), and maximally drafted the report by adding them into the citation. Some of us can never happy as it is.
 3. My full name is Ahmed M. Mohamed
 4. Pagination: use Roman numbers for the preliminary pages – from start to page 11. Page 1 and 2 are repeated twice on two separate pages each – please rectify
 5. Executive summary
 - the County Government of Garissa - capitalize the county and government
 6. Definition of terminologies
 - Agropastoralism – in Garissa, rainfall is less than 350mm per annum and therefore can't fit into the stated definition. Maybe we point to the fact that there supplementation of water through irrigation and runoff floodwater harvesting
 - Livestock cafes – close the bracket after “transdisciplinary researchers”.
 - Rangelands and other parts of the report – Kenya is known to use UK English – replace native with indigenous
 7. Introduction
 - Harbor high biodiversity is repeated twice (line 1 and 2) – delete one preferably the first one
- 1.2.1 Physical and topographic features
- Garissa is located 1,138 meters above sea level IS not correct but: The county rises from a low altitude of 20m to 400m above sea level is correct.
 - The annual rainfall ranges from 300 - 700 mm is not correct but: The average annual rainfall for the county is 275mm with the highest experienced in Ijara Sub-county (600 mm) and the lowest in Lagdera and parts of Balambala Sub-counties (200mm)
 - No of subcounties in Garissa is not seven Sub-Counties but 12 subcounties: ten operational sub-counties, namely Garissa Township, Ijara, Lagdera,

Balambala, Fafi, Hulugho, Bothai, Liboi, Shanta Abaq, and Dadaab, with two more, Sankuri and Benane, gazetted but not yet operational.

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8. Areas of assessment

- In Abdisamid – were collected data from Qarsa and a site some 1-2 km from Abdisamid (can't see this second site in Table 1 on page 20 or you combined results from the 2 sites)
- Page 23 – **conduct field assessments** – Garissa University was left out yet all other institutions.

9. 4.1 Ecological indicators

Table 5 and 6 should have come immediately they were introduced but as they are now they are from page 57. Similarly, respective figures to follow immediately after introducing them.

Cyperus Spp – there are two types of Cyprus (1) is *C. rotundus*, which is most common along the River Tana and a seasonal *Cyperus* sp (locally called Go-oose) that common away from the river deep in the hinterland. You must be referring to this one as *C. rotundus*. Till we get the correct scientific name let us call it Cyprus sp.

10. Maalimin hub

- “PGIS mapping in Maalimin highlights a clearly defined seasonal grazing system (Fig. 26). Grazing areas are divided into wet and dry season zones”. **From my experience, seasonal grazing in the area is not is clearly planned and implemented as stated. There is no much planning on this but the stakeholders need to bring out this clearly. The case was true during and before colonial periods.**
- **Fig 26. Put names of towns and centres on the map for clarity.**

11. Page 78 - Sankuri Hub

- “In Sankuri, the absence of clearly defined dry and wet season grazing zones **in communal areas** has created a significant gap in rangeland management (Fig. 27). Without distinct seasonal areas, livestock graze continuously across the same regions throughout the year.”. **This statement is for communal areas and not on land owned by individuals and group farms hence need to make specific to communal areas.** This position is supported by paragraph 2 on the same page.

12. Fig. 27 - the most active marketing route moves along the road parallel to the River Tana coming from Balich – Sankuri to Garissa Town. Most of livestock, crop and natural resource products move along these route some coming even from as far as Balamabala, Saka, Balich, sankuri to Garissa Town. Please indicate this on the map.

Put names of towns and centres on the map for clarity.

13. Policy Implications

- Recommendations for the two different hubs apply to both. Let us merge and have one
- Also add – germplasm conservation in form of in-situ, ex-situ and circa-situ (plantings of pastures and fodder on farm), silages and hay making
- Treatment and vaccination of livestock and IPM on farms
- Capacity building on value addition, marketing and entrepreneurial development

I will add more inputs later.